

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

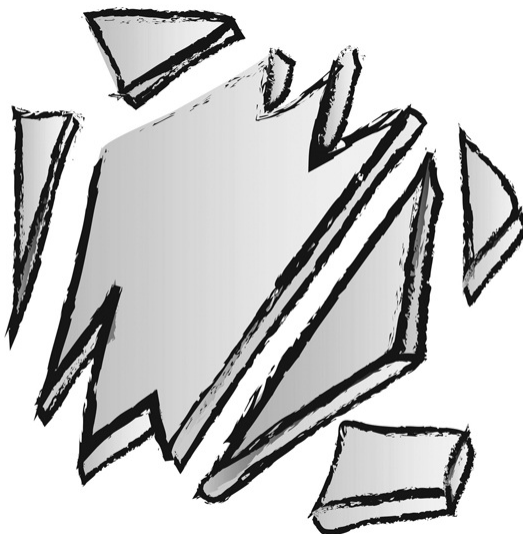
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Let's Start!

Seven years bad luck!



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know why a broken mirror is seven years bad luck?
- Have you ever broken a mirror? Did you have any bad luck afterwards?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can talk about things I was supposed to do and things that were supposed to happen.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.





Let's Explore!

What are the **antidotes*** to reverse the curse of the broken mirror?

* "Antidotes" are medicines or other remedies for counteracting the effects of poison, disease, or a curse.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Jerry from New York wants to know, "why is a broken mirror seven years bad luck?"

I actually know this one. This superstition was created by the Romans who believed that life was supposed to renew again every seven years. Damaging a mirror was viewed the same as damaging one's health. It was thought that this curse could only be corrected in the next seven year cycle.

This sounds like it would turn into a great excuse not to do anything.

I imagine, these things were said in ancient Rome before the "broken mirror bad luck" curse:

"if I ate less, I would lose more weight" or "if I were younger, I would fight that gladiator." Or finally, "I would conquer Mongolia if I liked the cold." and your friends would all laugh at you.

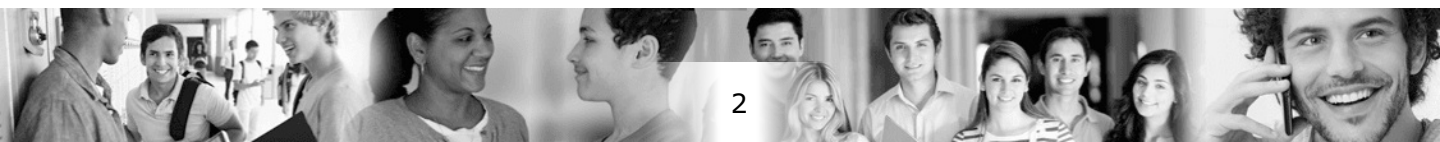
However, with the broken mirror excuse all you have to say is, "I broke a mirror last night, so I guess I can't make the next invasion of Germany. Sorry."

Fortunately, with many superstitions, there are some antidotes to counter it. Here are a few:

If you break a mirror you are supposed to throw salt over your shoulder.

If you break a mirror you are supposed to immediately spin around three times in a counterclockwise direction. Finally, you should take a piece of the broken mirror and touch a tombstone with it. It is believed that this will lift the curse immediately.

Or, if you find yourself with a broken mirror, buy another mirror.





Let's Practice!

Do you believe in that superstition about the broken mirror? Some people can!

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Underline the incorrect word. Rewrite the correct sentences below. Practice pronunciation with a partner by reading the sentences aloud.

1. There are many superstitions that was created a long time ago.
2. Damaging a mirror were considered equivalent to damaging your health.
3. Romans thought the curse was correct in the next seven year cycle.
4. Many excuses are used in ancient Rome when someone broke a mirror.
5. A ritual was believe to lift the curse immediately.



Let's Practice!

Stacie talks to Joe about her blog entry.

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Complete the gaps with the expression "supposed to" and its corresponding conjugation. Use the verbs provided, e.g. You weren't supposed to believe in superstitions.

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Stacie: Did you read my blog? There are some interesting things about this superstition on broken mirrors!

Joe: I did! They believed life _____ itself every seven years.

Stacie: And that is why bad luck _____ for that long.

Joe: Yeah, but they had their methods to fight the curse. They _____ salt over their shoulder.

Stacie: Or they _____ a silly ritual spinning around!

Joe: As far as I'm concerned, if I break a mirror, I _____ a new mirror. That's it!





Extension Activity

What does the fortune teller say?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In pairs, write a dialogue about 12-15 sentences long.
- One person has just broken a mirror and one person is the fortune teller.
- The fortune teller must explain all the bad things that can happen.
- The fortune teller must explain what the other person is supposed to do.
- The fortune teller must also offer a possible antidote to reverse the curse.
- Give advice using "If I were you ..."
- Change partners.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐ ☐

I can talk about things I was supposed to do and things that were supposed to happen.

☐ ☐

I can talk about hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **curse** (noun): a difficult time caused by a bad superstition
e.g. This curse could be corrected in a seven year cycle.
- **to conquer** (verb): to win in a war
e.g. I would conquer any country in winter if I liked the cold.
- **Mongolia** (noun): a country in Asia, between Russia and China
e.g. I would conquer Mongolia if I liked the cold.
- **gladiator** (noun): a fighter in shows in ancient Rome
e.g. If I were younger, I would fight that gladiator.
- **invasion** (noun): the entrance in an enemy territory by an army
e.g. I can't make the next invasion of Germany.
- **antidote** (noun): something that prevents or works against negative effects
e.g. With many superstitions there are some antidotes.
- **to counter** (verb): to oppose; to block
e.g. You can counter the broken mirror superstition.
- **to spin** (verb): to rotate rapidly
e.g. You're supposed to spin three times.
- **counterclockwise** (adverb): in the opposite direction of the movement of the hands of a clock
e.g. Spin in a counterclockwise direction.





Learning Points

Be Supposed to

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the past, present or future.

The structure is:

subject + to be + supposed to + verb

*You **are supposed to** throw salt over your shoulder.*

*I **am supposed to** spin around three times.*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say be supposed to, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Examples:

- *Romans who believed that life was supposed to renew again every seven years.*
- *If you break a mirror you are supposed to throw salt over your shoulder.*
- *You are supposed to immediately spin around three times.*





Learning Points

The Passive Voice

You use an active structure when you want the "doer" of the action to be the subject.
You use a passive structure when you want the "receiver" of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = The Romans (subject) **created** the superstition about the broken mirror.

Passive sentence = The broken mirror superstition (subject) **was created** by the Romans.
It is not necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of *to be* followed by the past participle.

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

*The curse **was lifted**.*

Examples:

- *This superstition was created by the Romans.*
- *Damaging a mirror was viewed the same as damaging one's health.*
- *It was thought that this curse could only be corrected in the next seven year cycle.*

